

Practical Predictive AI Evaluation

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Overview

We'll discuss important considerations relevant to evaluating AI tools and making sense of their predictions in clinical/healthcare practice:

- How might we use AI-based predictions, and what performance metrics are relevant to each use case?
 - Discrimination metrics
 - Calibration metrics
- What information about the model do we need to know to use it responsibly?

Predictive AI

Use cases and associated performance metrics

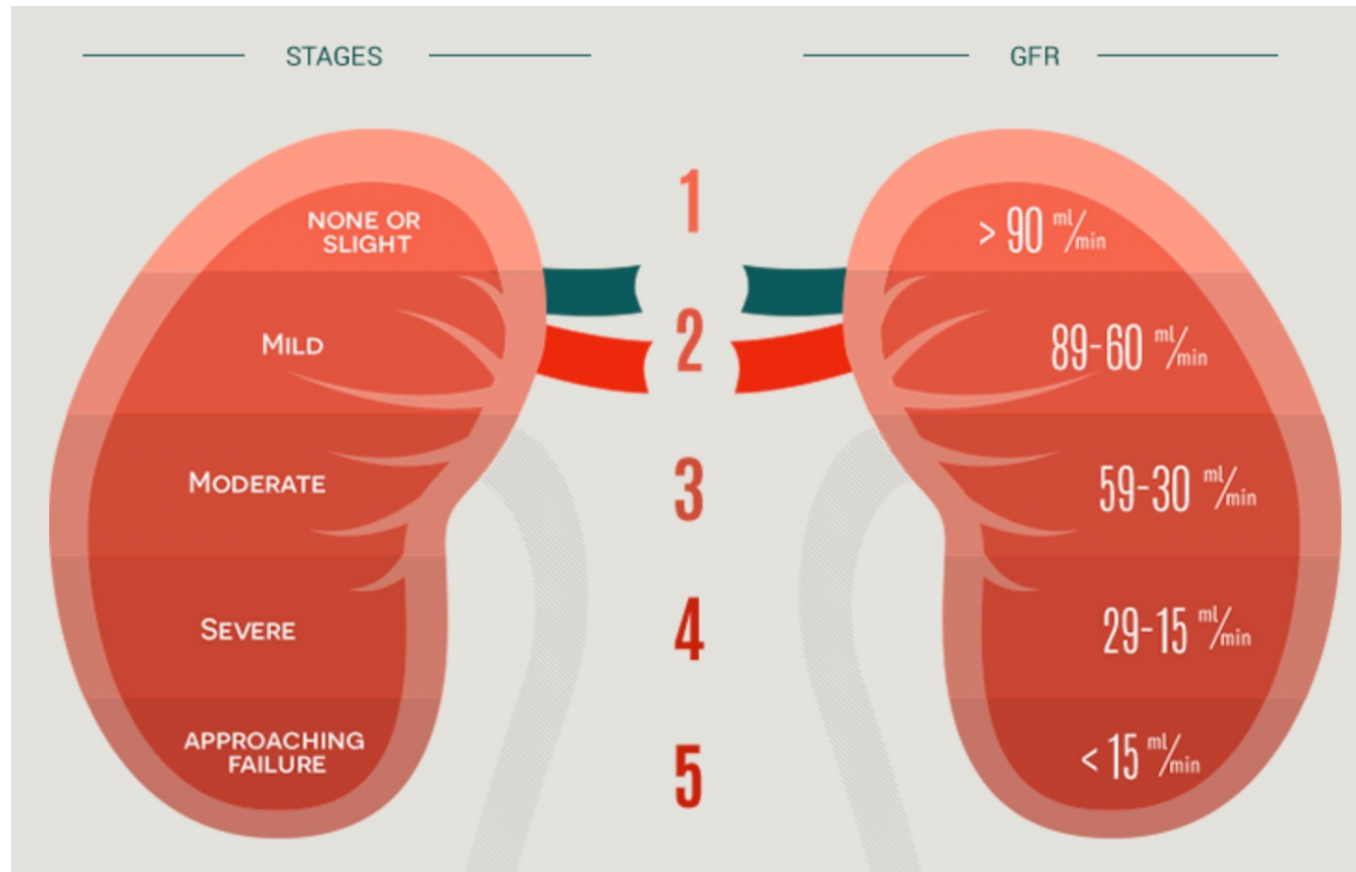
New Stage IV Risk Prediction Model

Some of your colleagues have implemented a new prediction model that aims to prevent or delay kidney failure by predicting 2-year risk of progression to stage IV CKD.

This model is based on electronic health record data, including diagnosis and procedure codes, medications, labs, and vitals; as well as social determinants of health.

You think the model sounds promising and start thinking about ways you might use it in practice.

Prediction: Probability of a Binary Outcome



11%

Probability of Stage IV CKD within two years

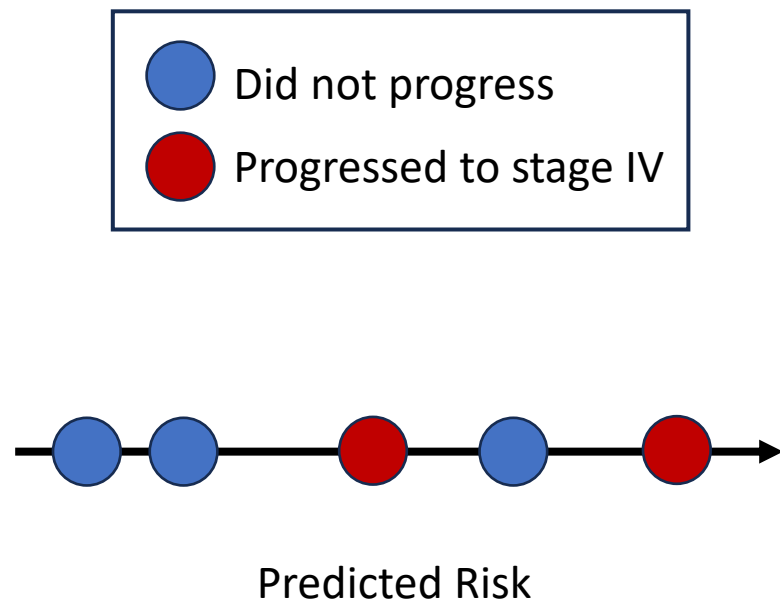
Report Back:

- How might you use this number in clinical practice (be specific)?
- What performance metrics are relevant to this way of using the prediction?

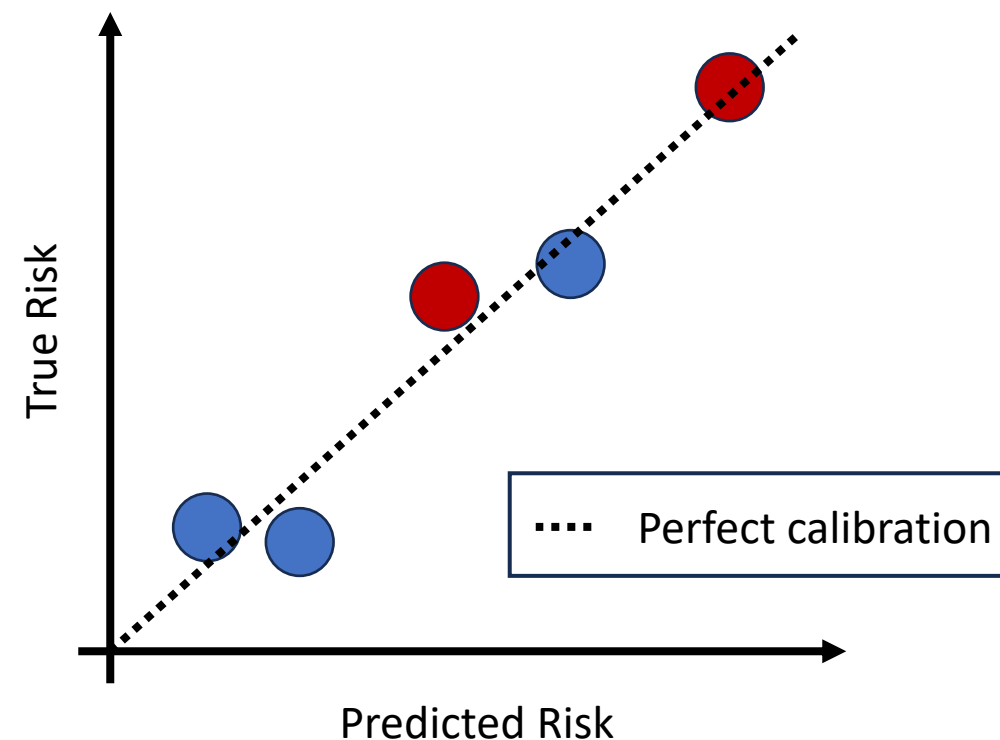
Discrimination

vs

Calibration



Can we identify individuals who will progress?



Are our predicted probabilities accurate?

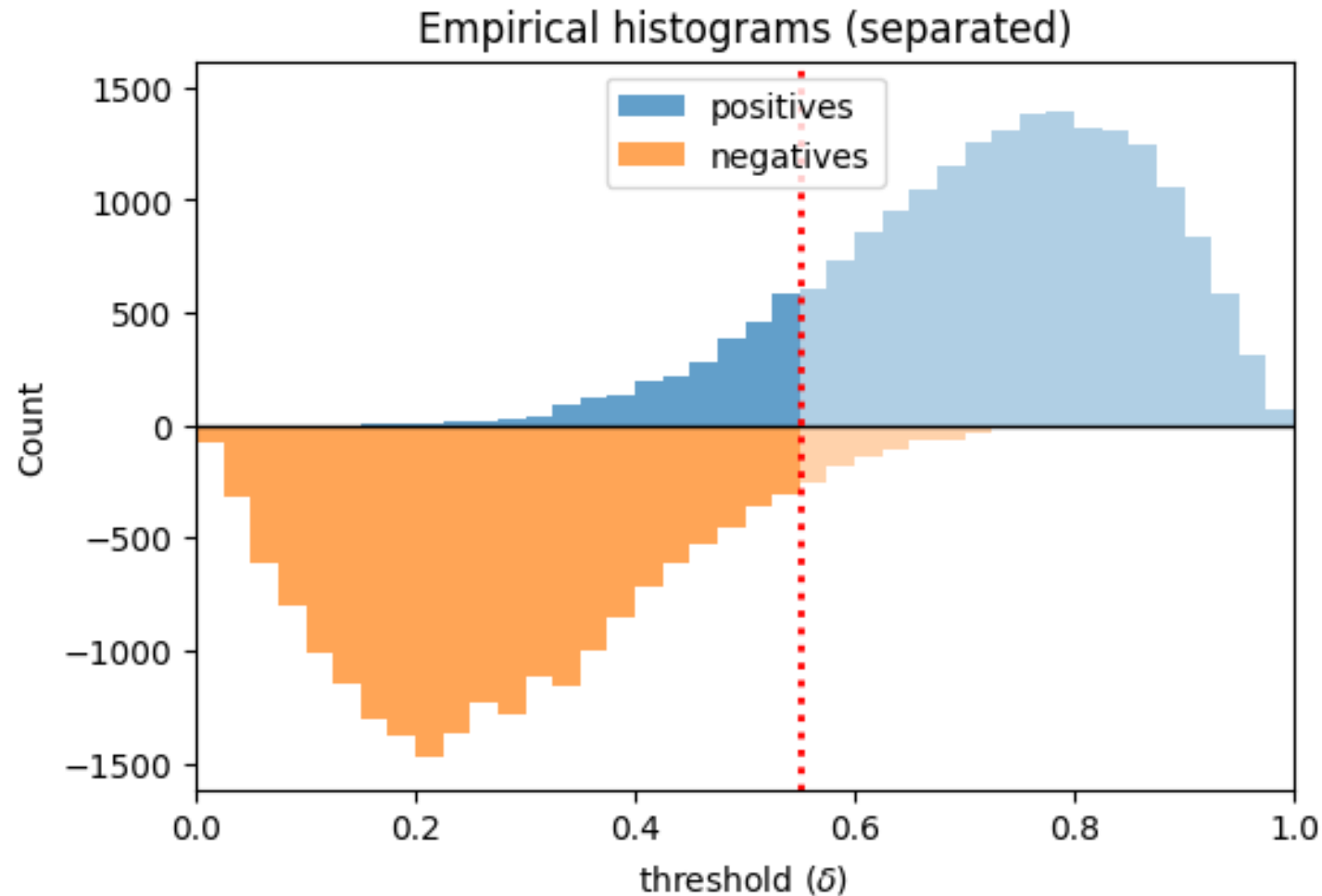
Assessing model discrimination

Sensitivity, specificity, PPV, NPV (threshold-based)

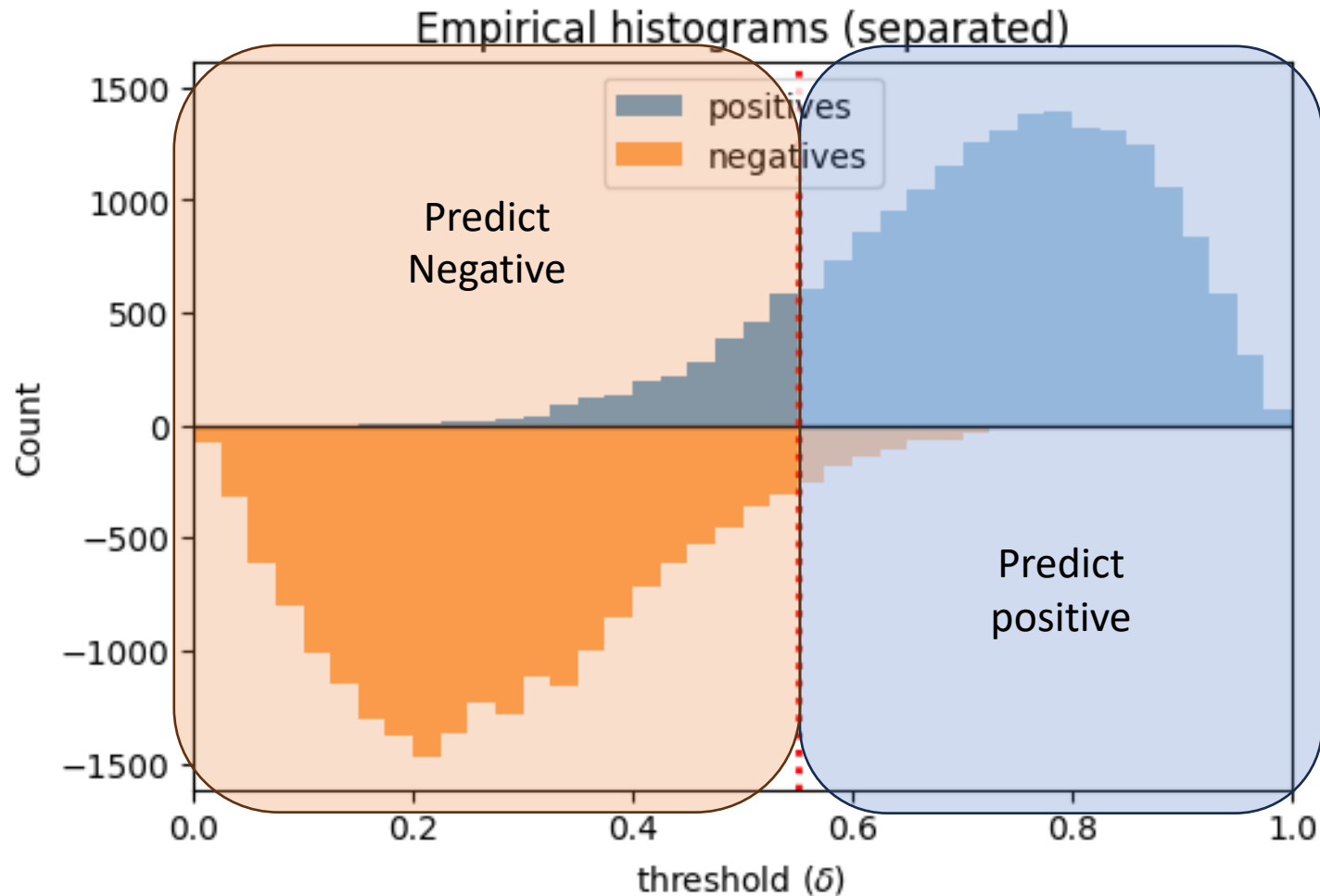
AUC, AUPRC (threshold-agnostic)

Suppose our features are highly informative.
What might our model's predictions look like?

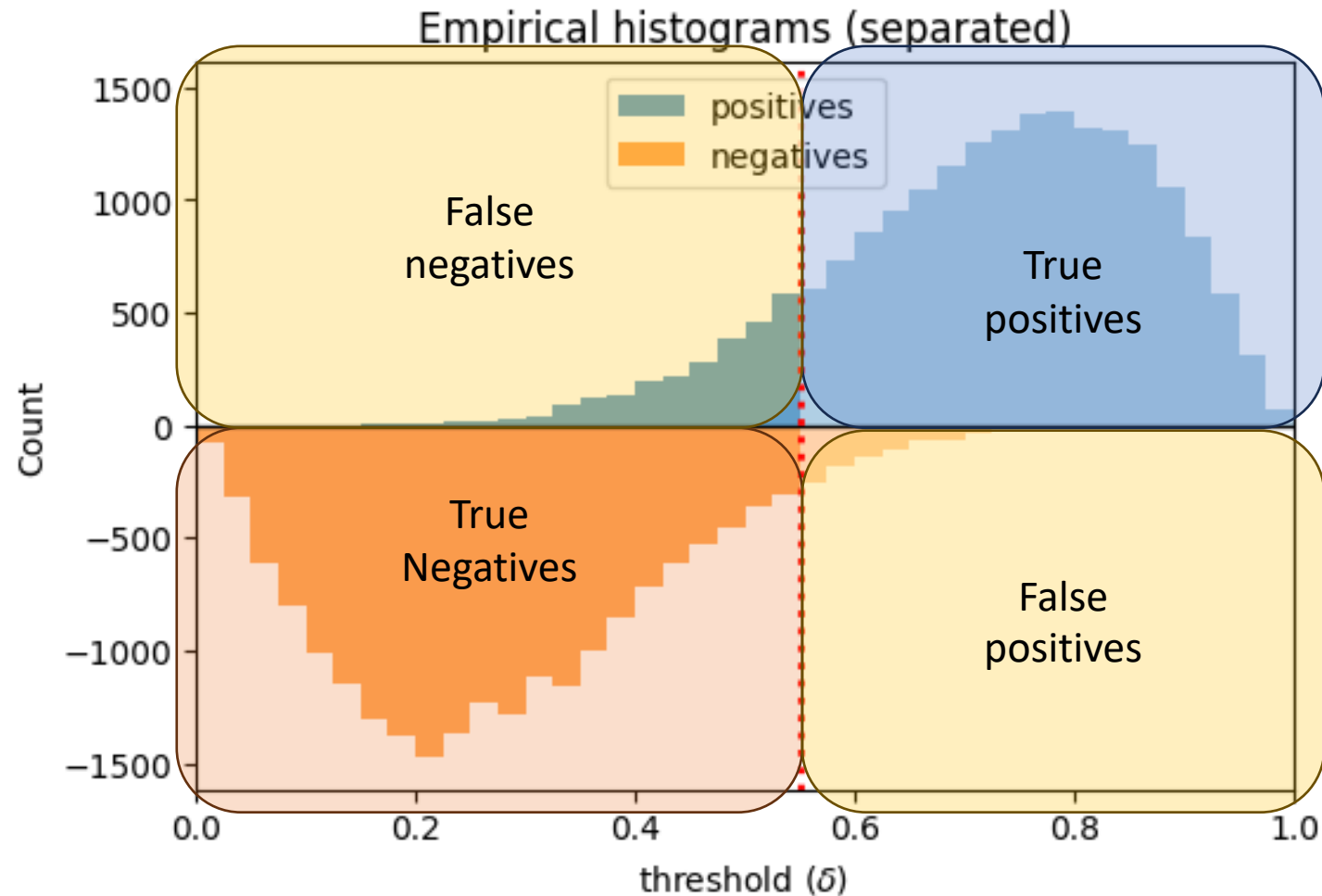
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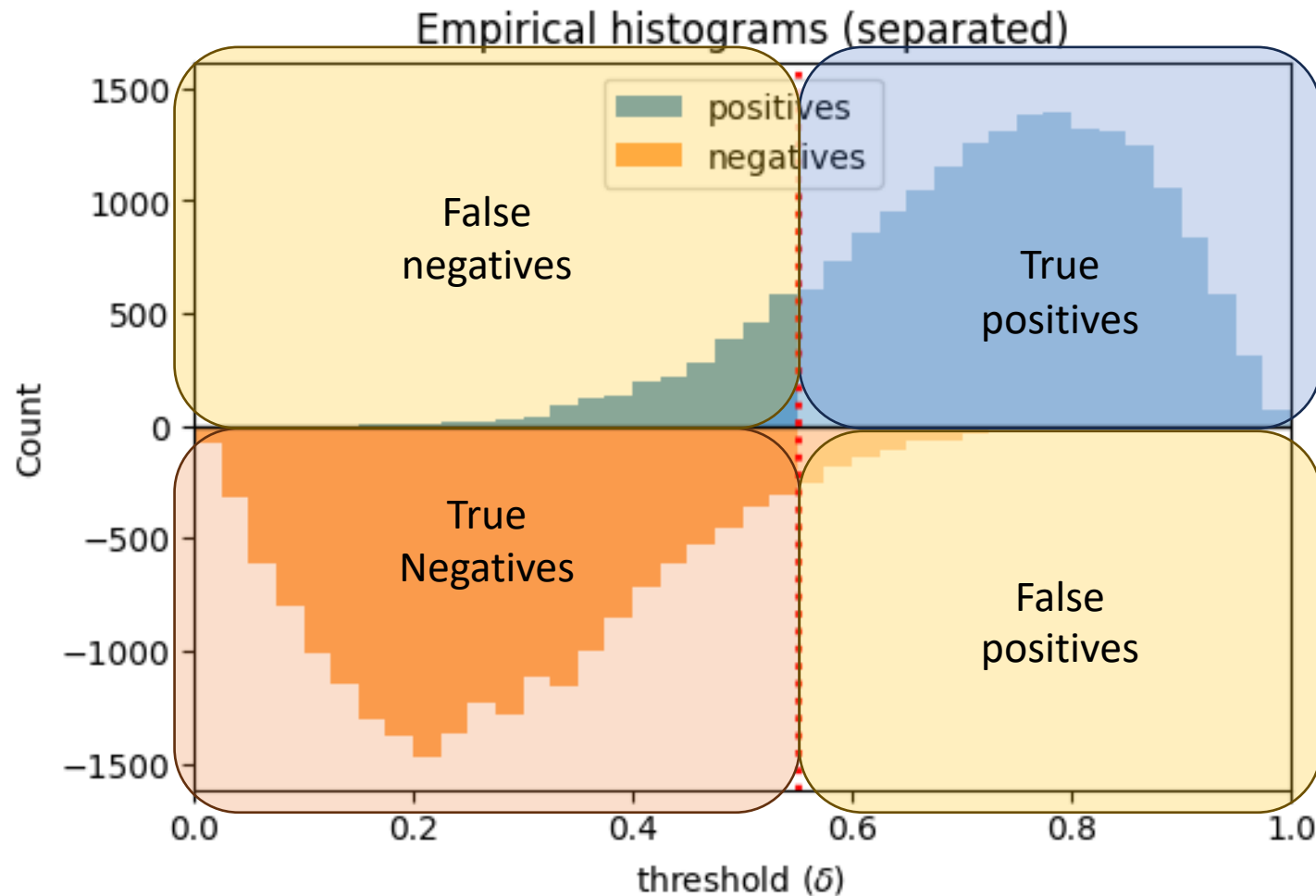
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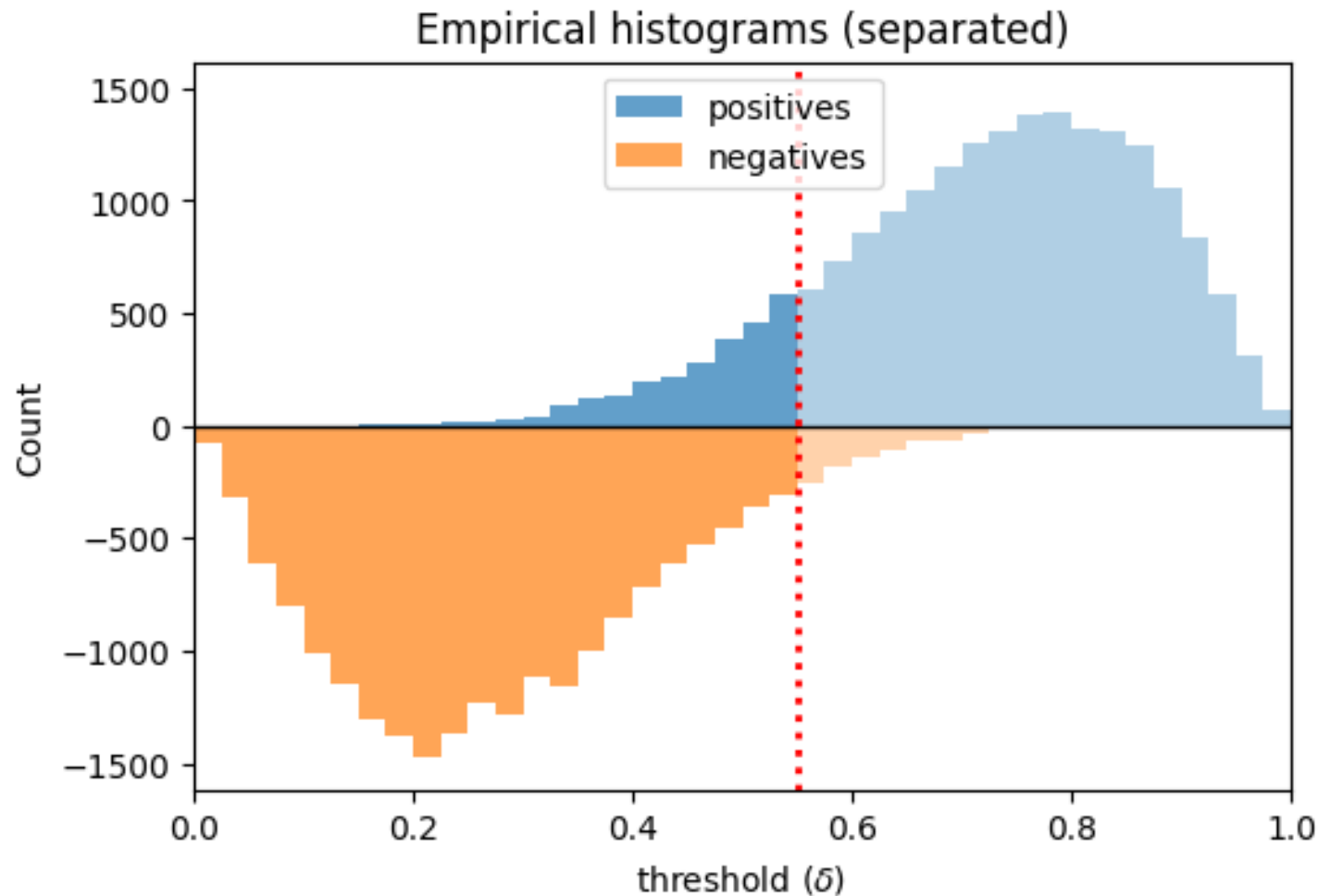


Review threshold-specific metrics:

- TPR (sensitivity, recall)
- FPR (1 – specificity)
- Precision (PPV)
- NPV

Consider the clinical utility of each!!

Consider: how does each metric change as we vary the threshold?

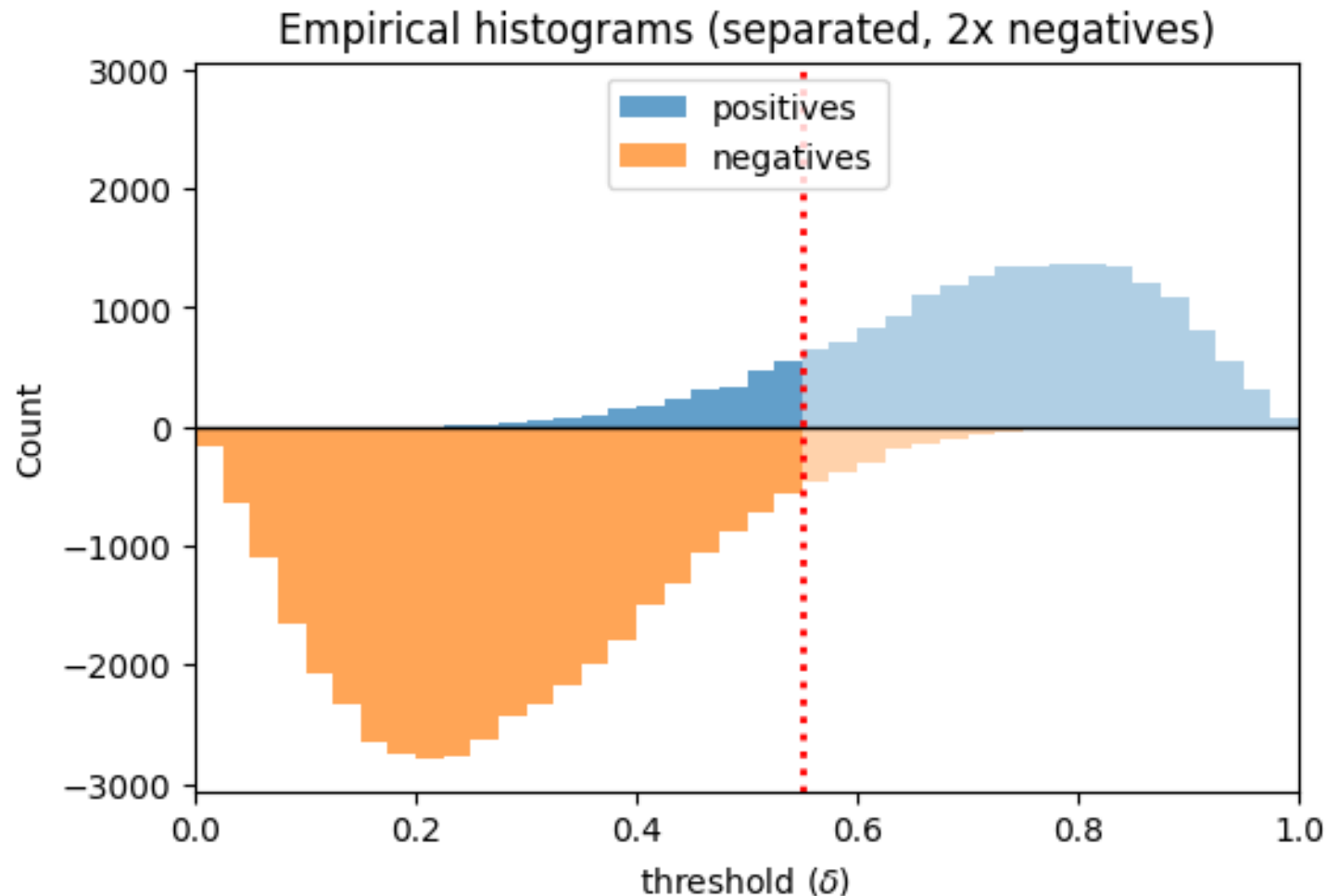


Review threshold-specific metrics:

- TPR (sensitivity, recall)
- FPR (1 – specificity)
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Consider the clinical utility of each!!

Consider: how does each metric change as we vary class balance?

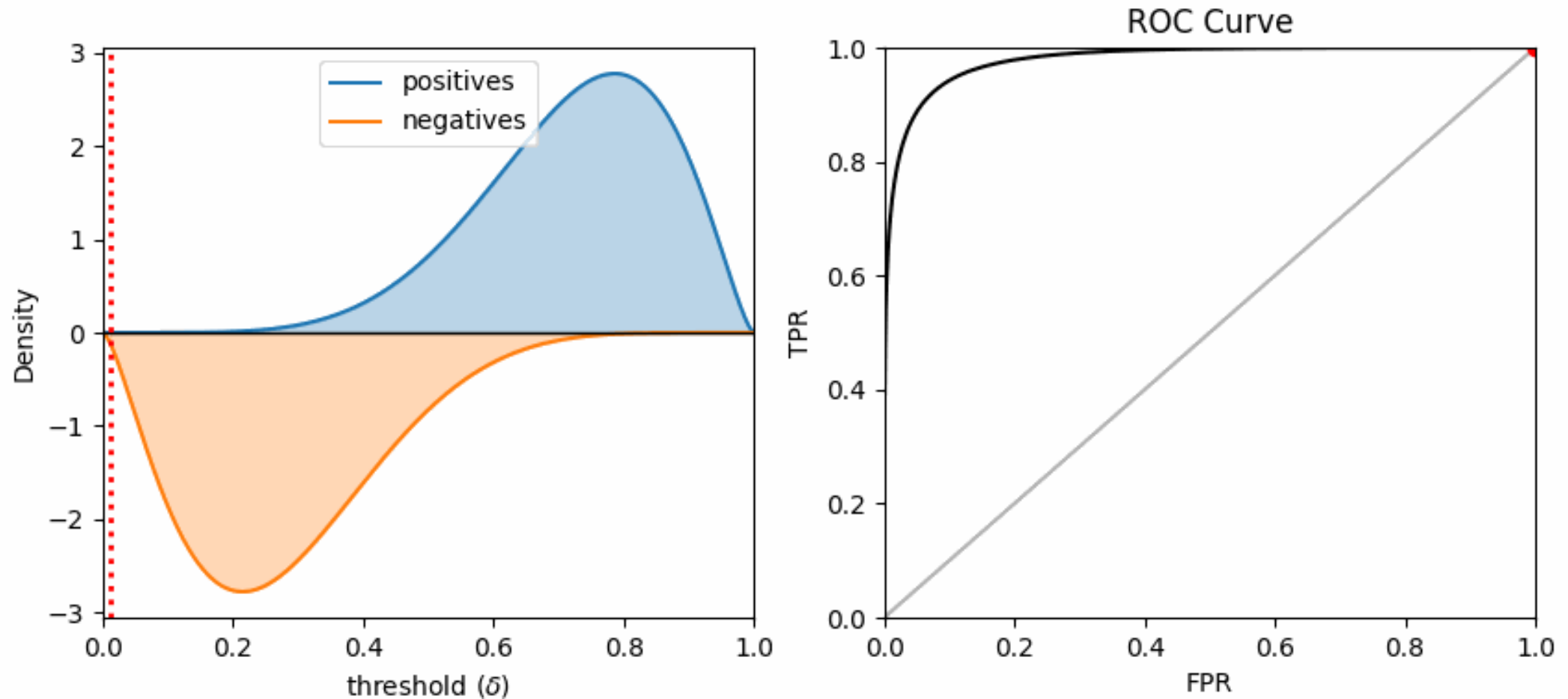


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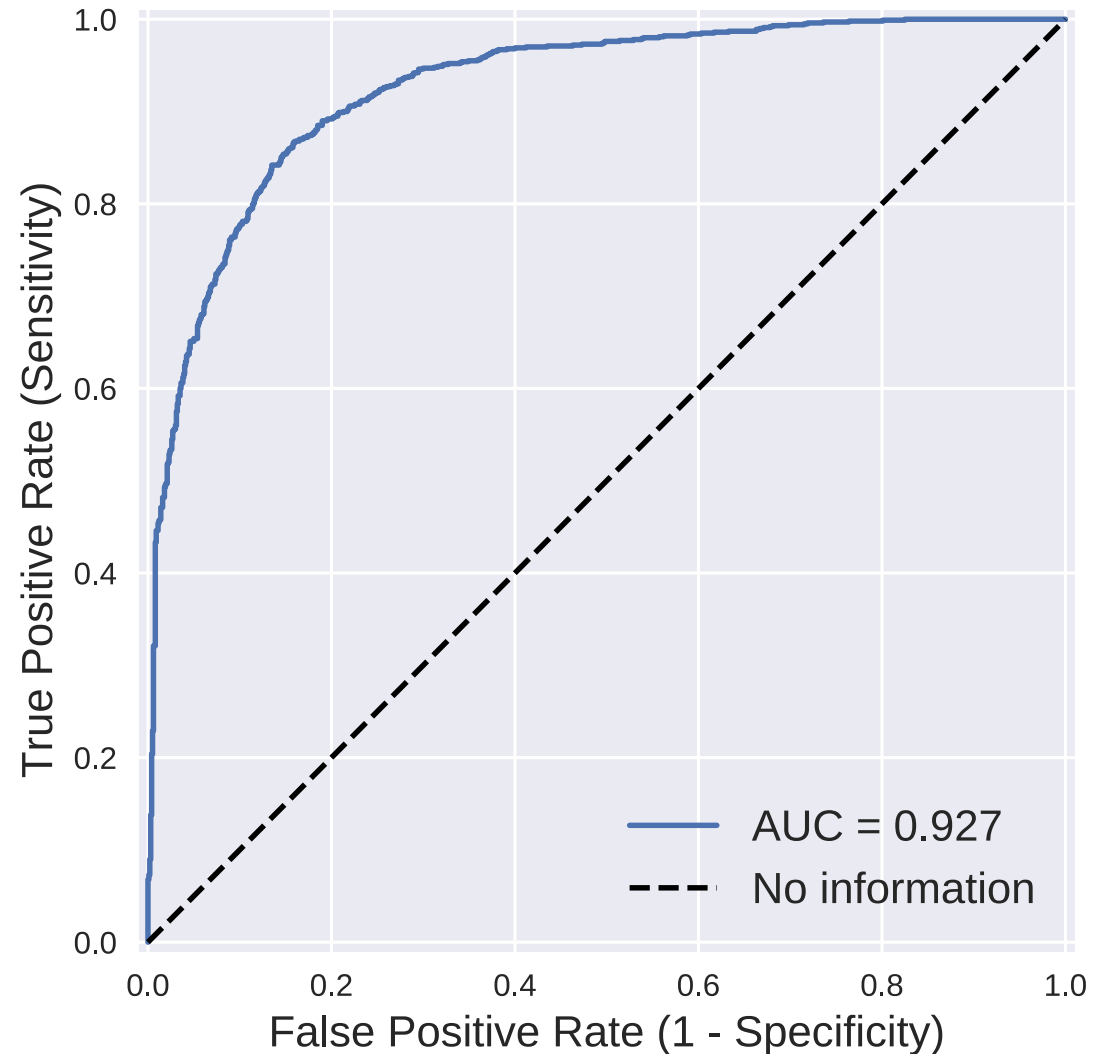
Consider the clinical utility of each!!

Consider: how does each metric change as we vary the threshold?



Receiver Operating Characteristic Curve

- Illustrates the tradeoff between the TPR (sensitivity) and FPR (1–specificity) as we vary the threshold.
- Allows clinicians to consider this tradeoff and select appropriate operating points
- The area under this curve (AUC) provides a single number summarizing this tradeoff.
- In most cases this is the most important metric (why??)

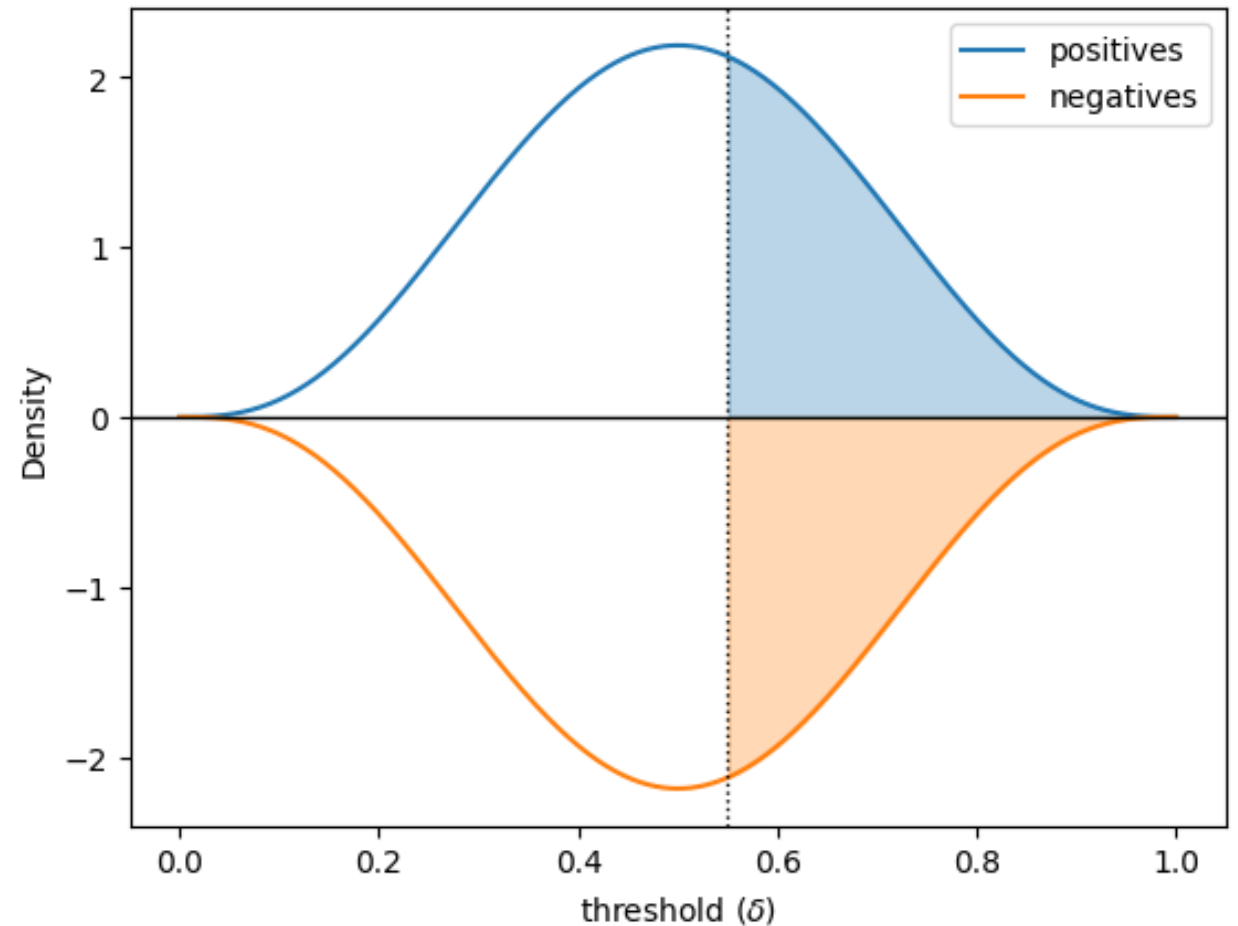


So, what's a *good* AUC value?
(i.e., *good* performance)?

We'll start to answer this question by taking a look at *bad* performance.

Suppose our features contain no information about the outcome. What might predictions look like?

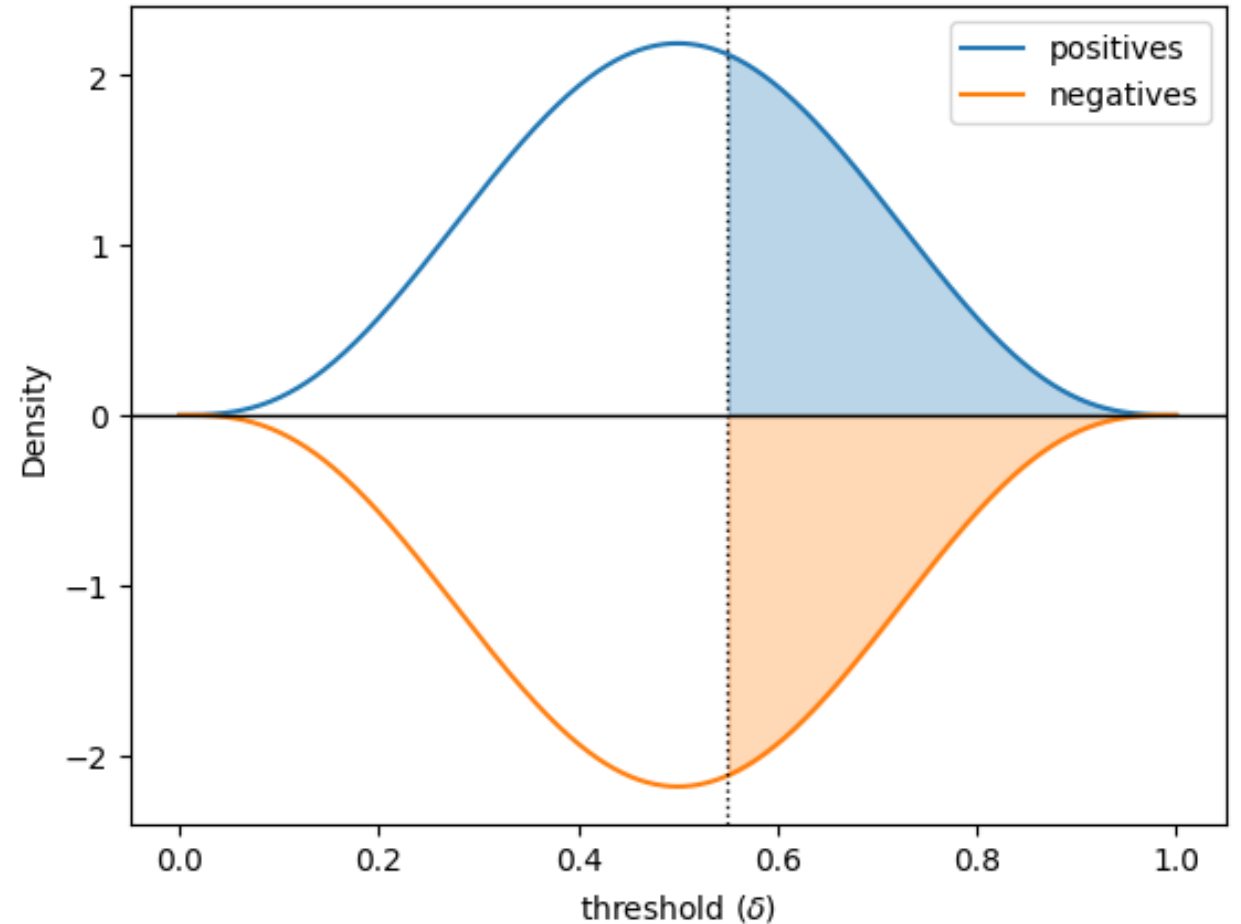
- Similar distributions between positive and negative cases.
- The predicted value tells you nothing about which one it's more likely to be.



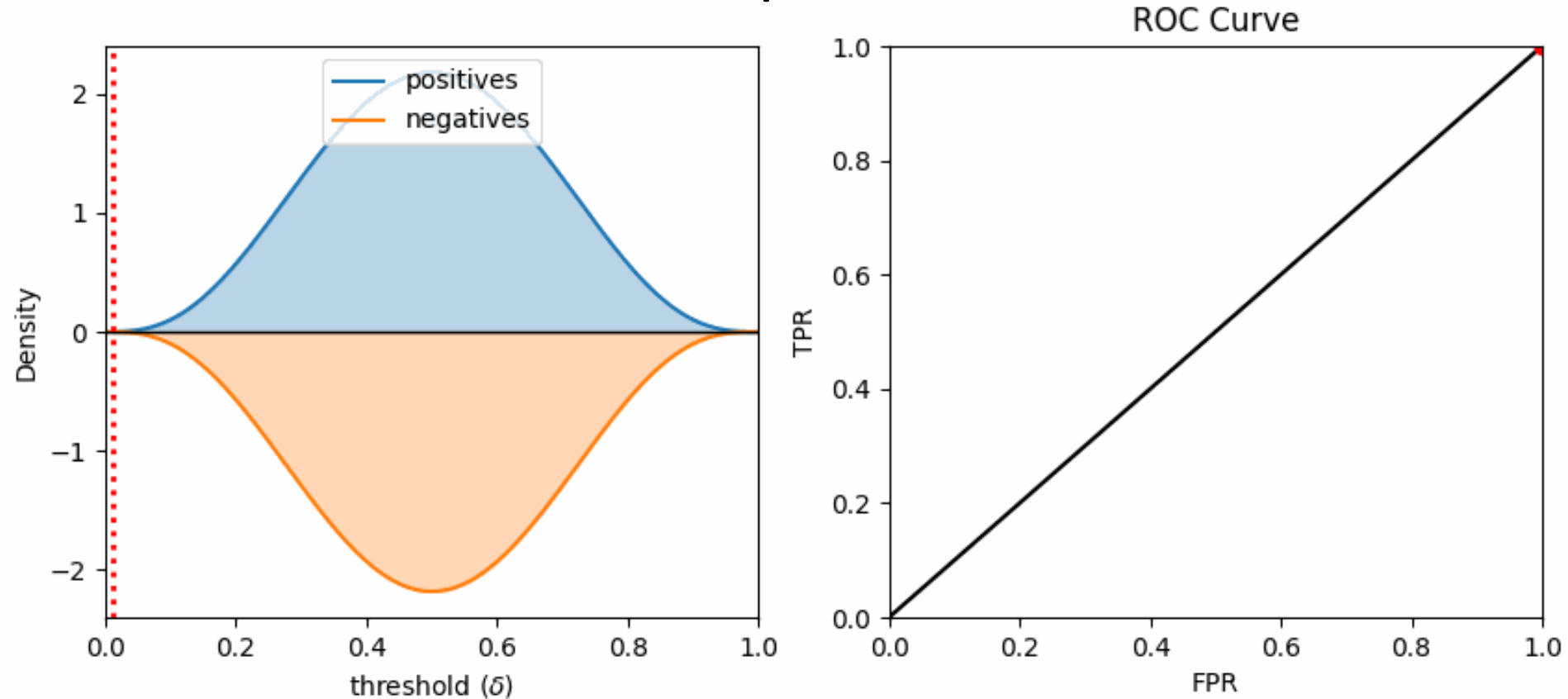
Suppose our features contain no information about the outcome. What might predictions look like?

What is the:

- (a) TPR (sensitivity)?
- (b) FPR ($1 - \text{specificity}$)?
- (c) PPV?



Our “no information” predictive model

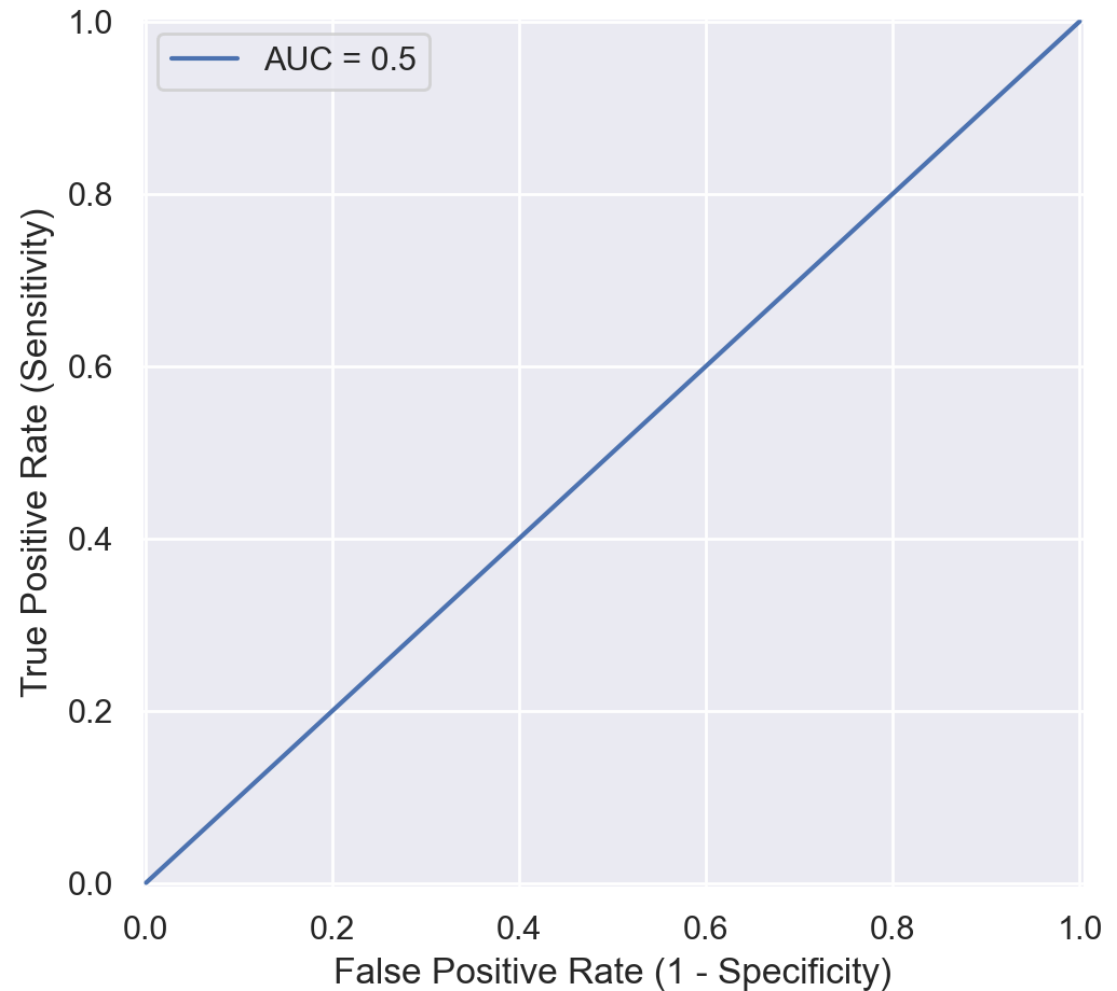


TPR and FPR always match (why?)

- the distributions of positive and negative cases match
- the corresponding CDFs match

Our “no information” model

- AUC is 0.5
- Do we ever see $AUC < 0.5$?
- If so, what can we infer about the distributions of our predictions for positive and negative samples?



So, what's a *good* AUC value? (i.e., *good* performance)?

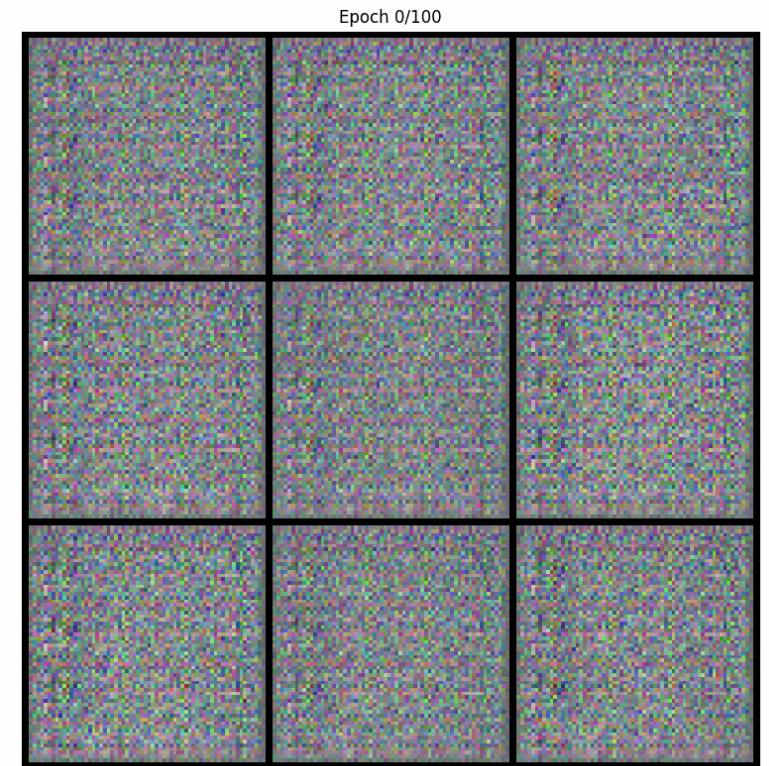
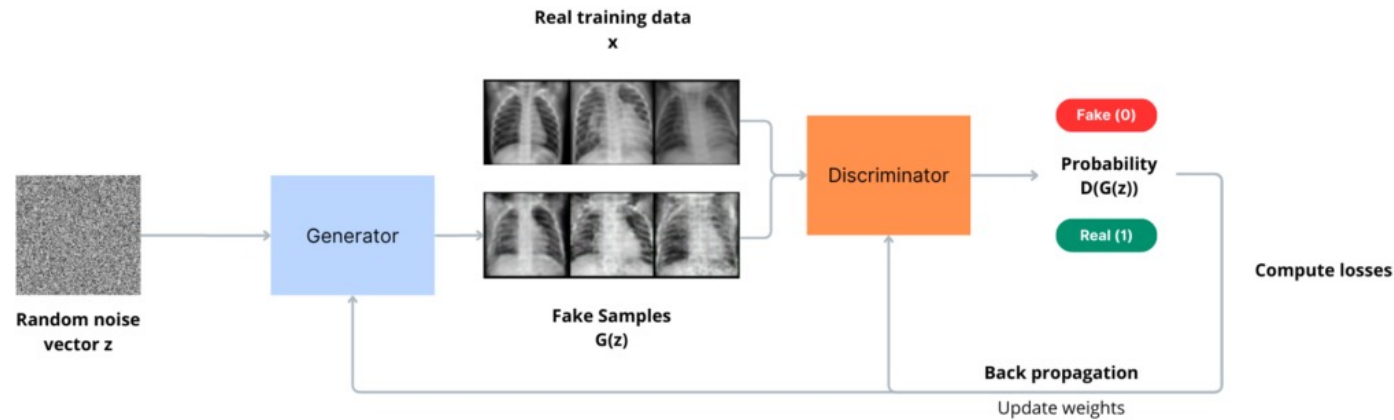
It depends.

- Are predictions better than random?
- Are predictions better than the previous best performing model?
- Are predictions better than expert performance?
- Does performance exceed our (informed) expectations?
- **Is the model clinically useful?**
- Different expectations for risk prediction vs classification

What can we say about prediction performance when distributions match?

- When distributions of predictions match between pos/neg:
 - predictions provide no information about the outcome
 - i.e. random guessing
- When distributions of features (observed or latent) match between pos/neg:
 - features contain no information about the outcome
- Note that adversarial methods operate on this principle:
 - Train a *discriminator* that predicts pos/neg (or real/fake)
 - Train a *generator* whose goal is to increase the discriminator's loss (many variations on this)
 - Result? Distribution matching

Brief overview of generative adversarial networks (GANs)



$$\min_G \max_D V(D, G) = \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} [\log D(\mathbf{x})] + \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p_{\mathbf{z}}(\mathbf{z})} [\log(1 - D(G(\mathbf{z})))]$$

We've quantified performance across all thresholds, but how do we use the model?

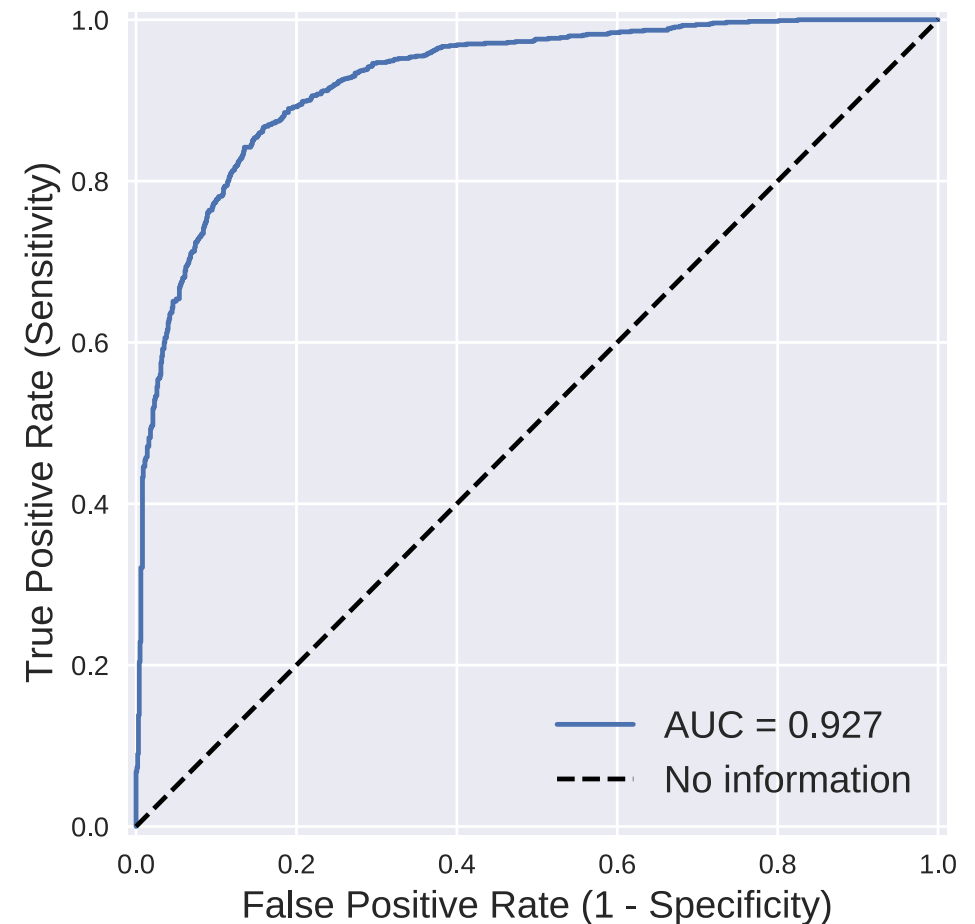
Sometimes the predicted probability really is what we care about.

- *Example*: probability of heart attack
- If so, we need to make sure our model is *calibrated*

More often, we need to pick a threshold so we can decide whether to:

- Alert a provider
- Get a biopsy
- Refer the patient
- etc

What threshold should we pick? What's the right tradeoff?



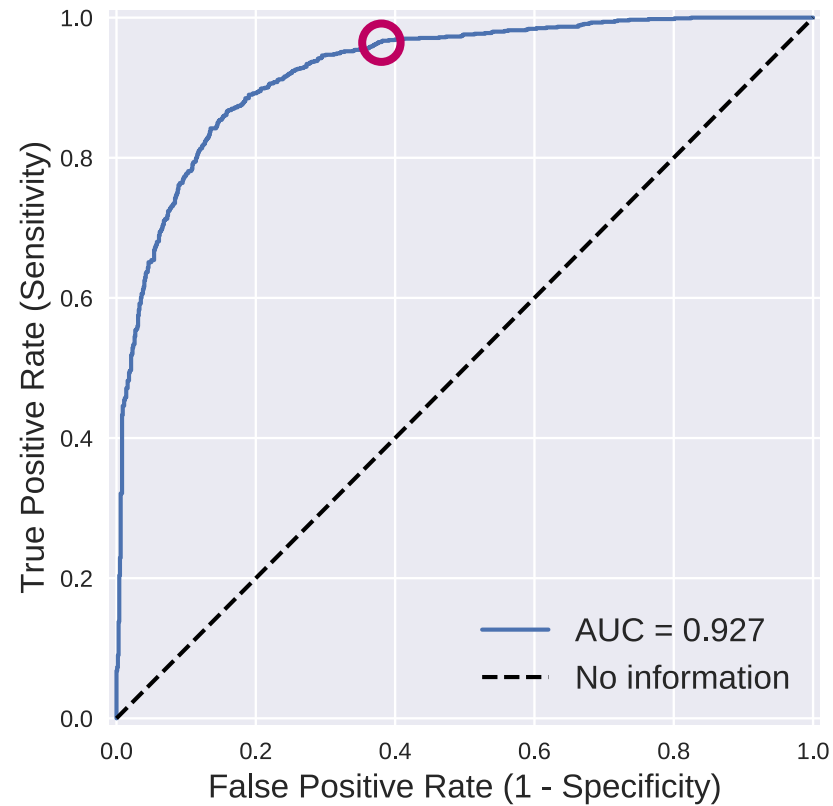
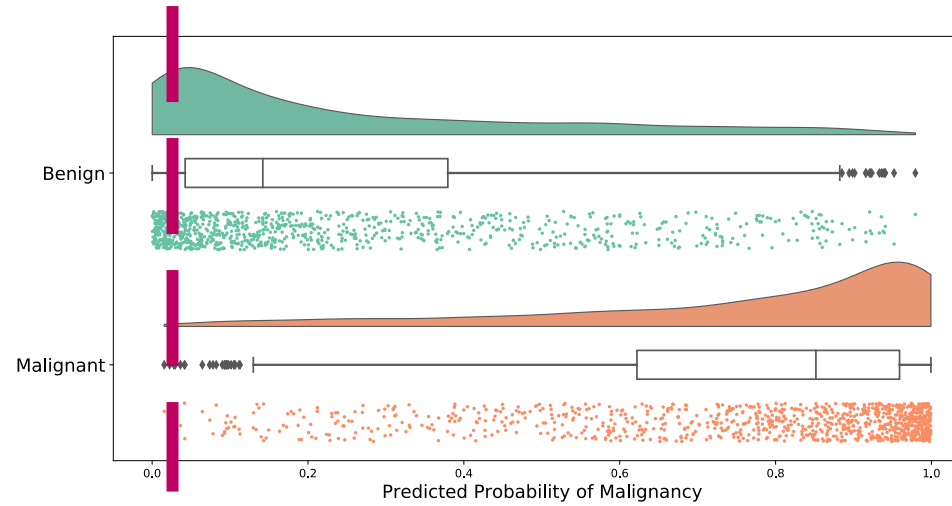
Healthcare Scenarios

Which performance metric is most important?

1. A computer vision model that detects carcinoma

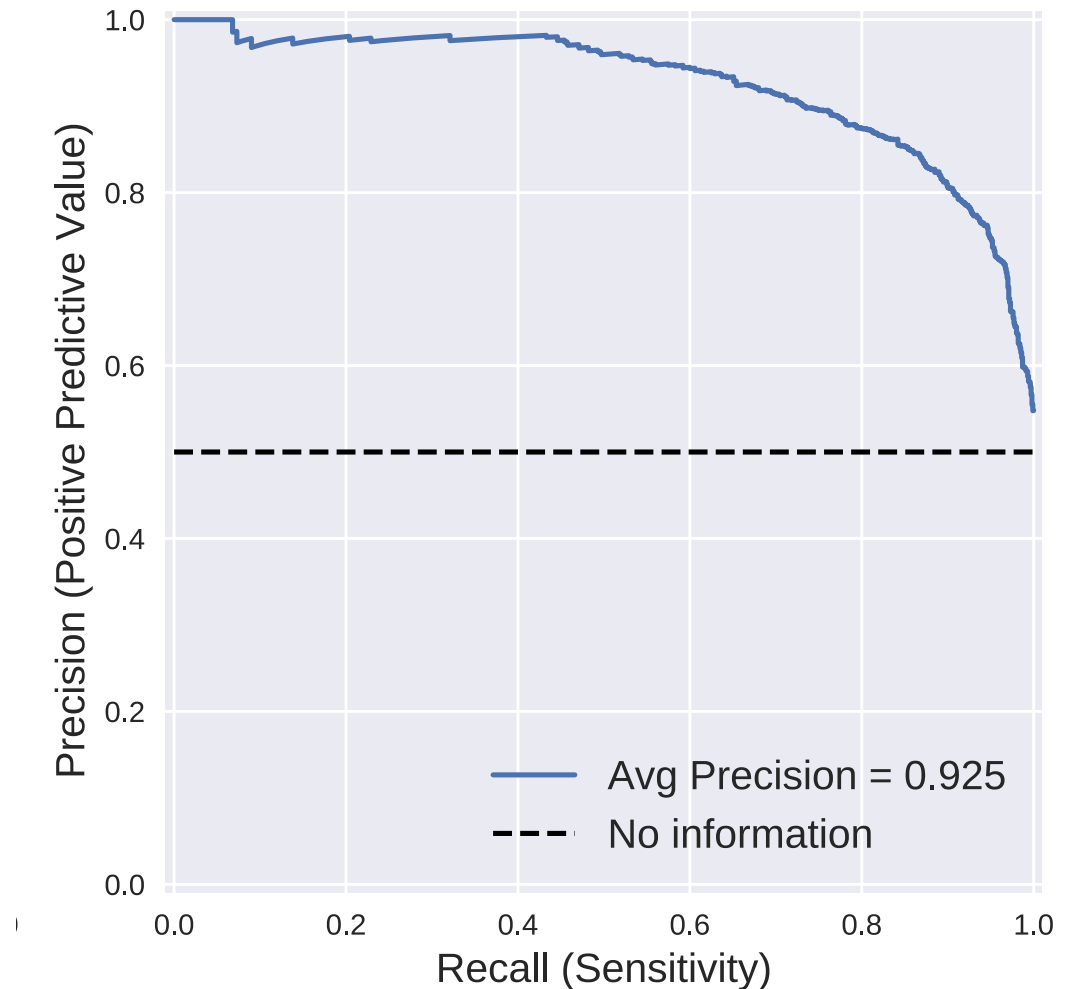
Operating Point:

high sensitivity

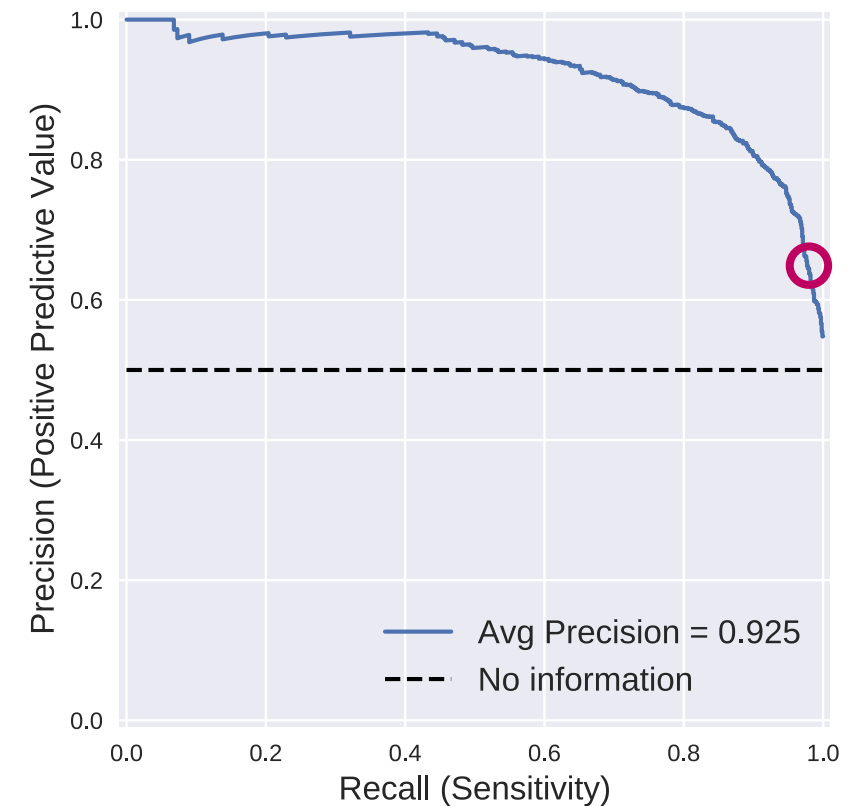
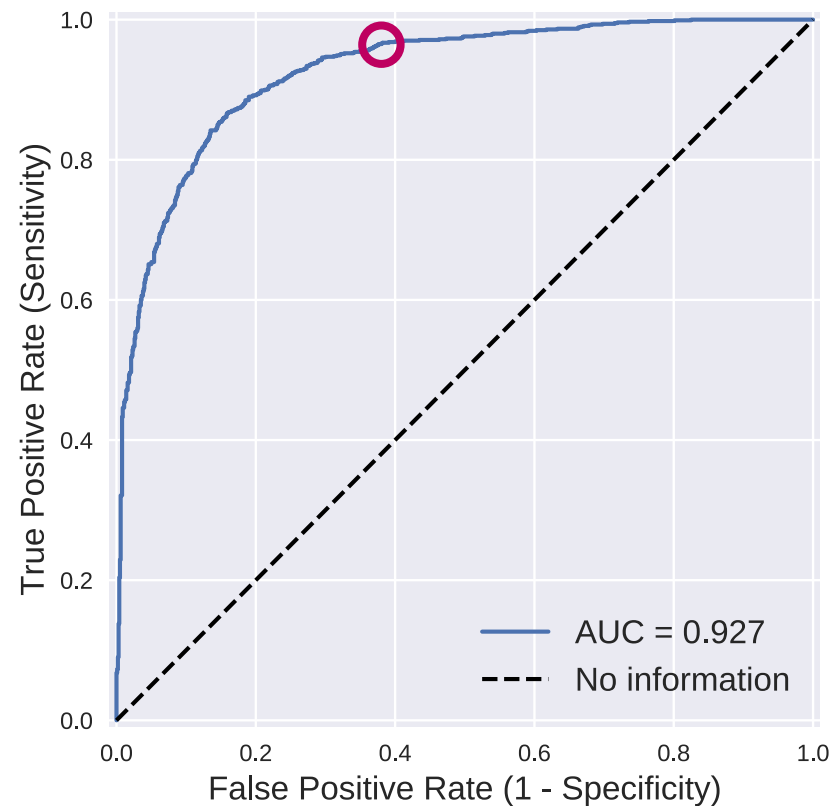
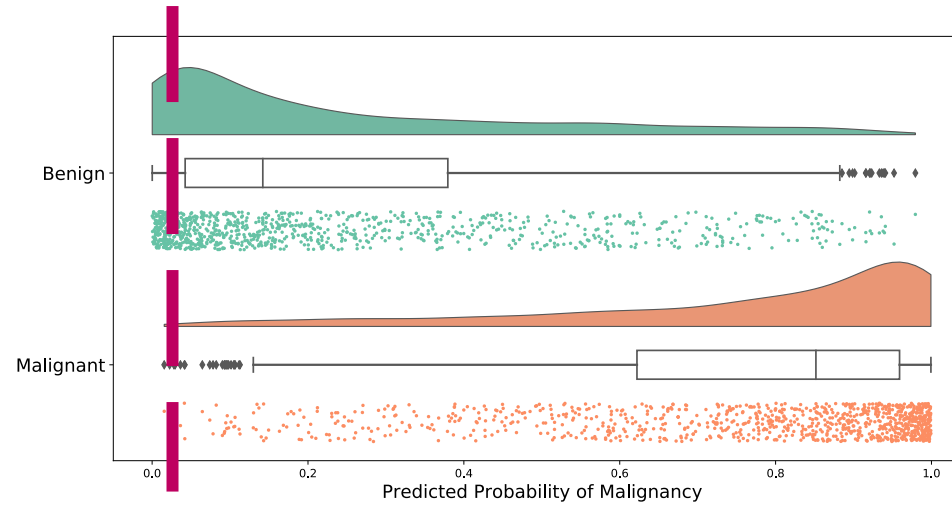


The Precision-Recall Curve (i.e., PPV-Sensitivity Curve)

- Some argue it has greater clinical relevance than the ROC curve
- The *no information* classifier always achieves PPV equal to the *base rate*, or *prevalence* (why?)
- PPV as well as the area under this curve (average precision) must be interpreted relative to prevalence



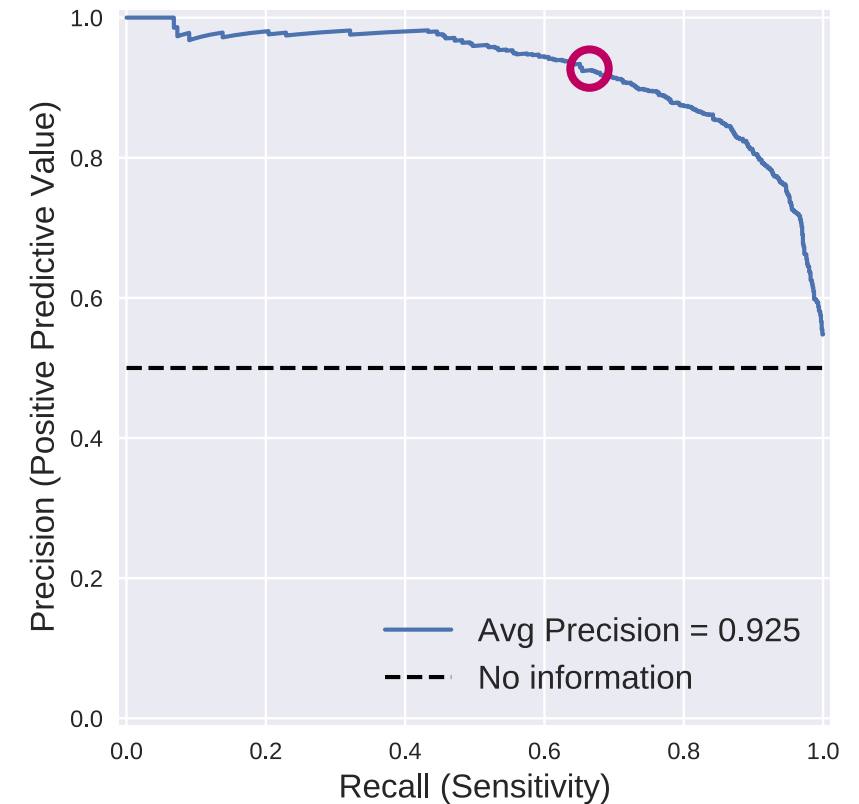
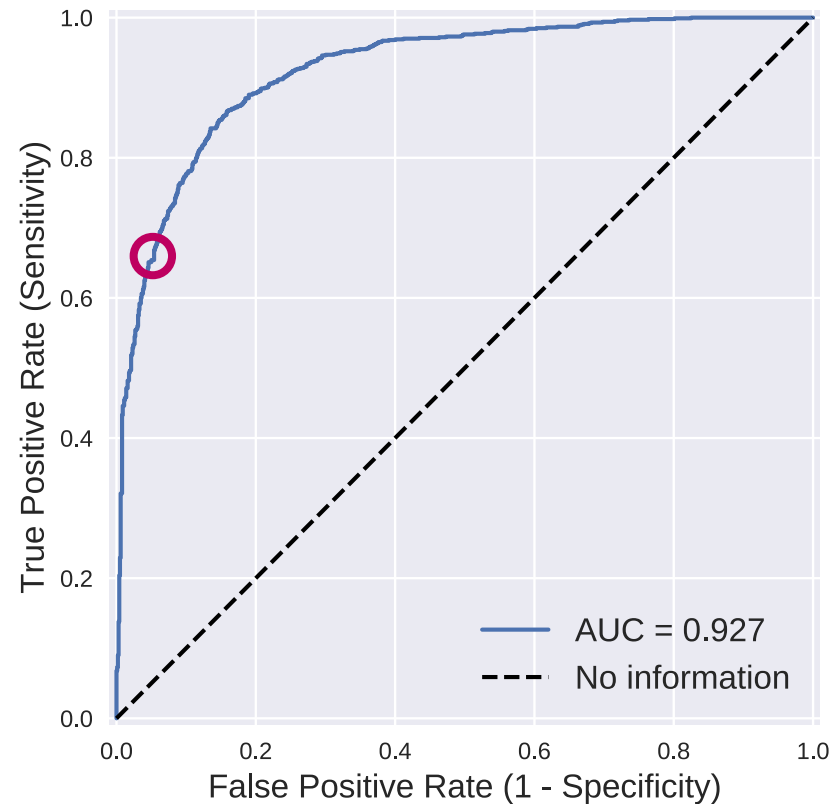
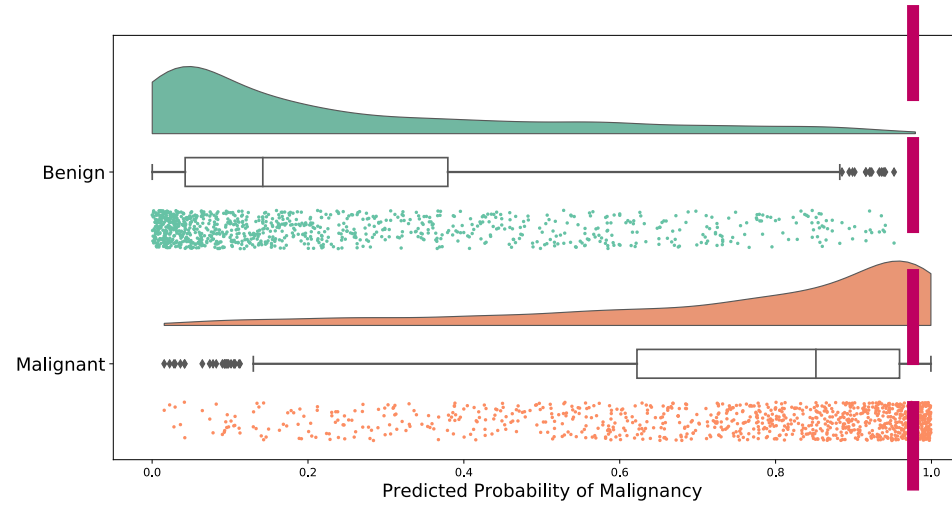
Operating Point:
high sensitivity



Healthcare Scenarios

1. A computer vision model that detects carcinoma
2. An algorithm that detects atrial fibrillation in Apple Watch users

Operating Point: *high specificity*

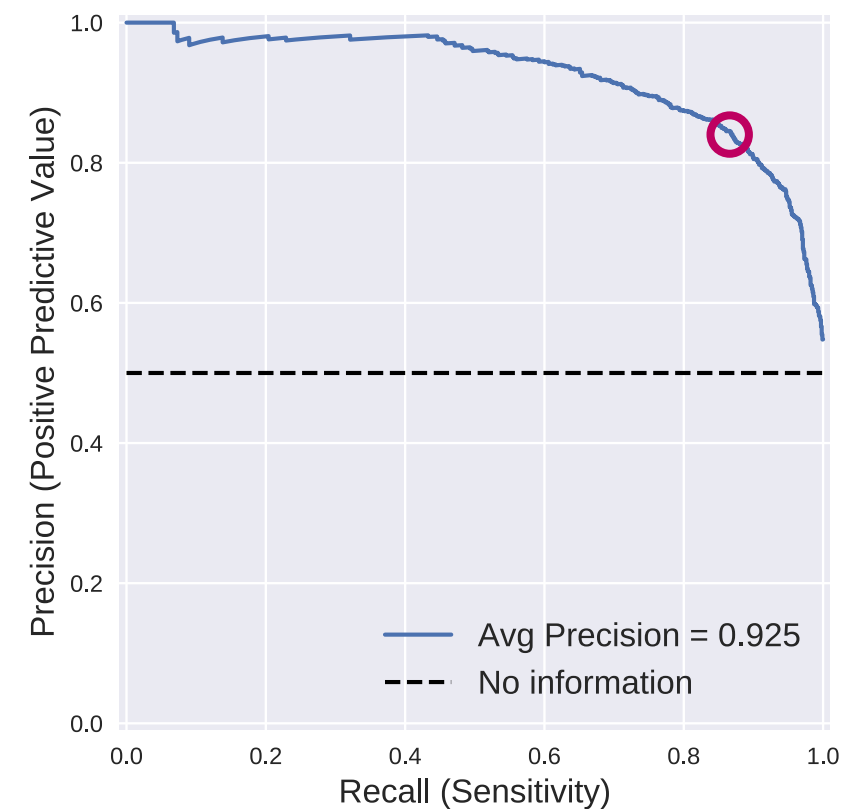
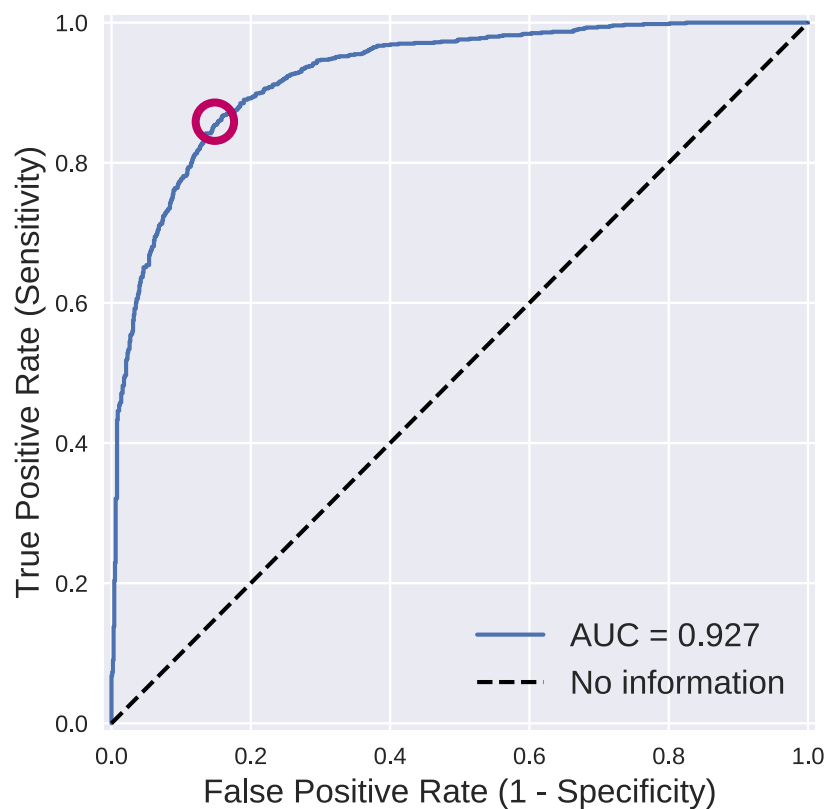
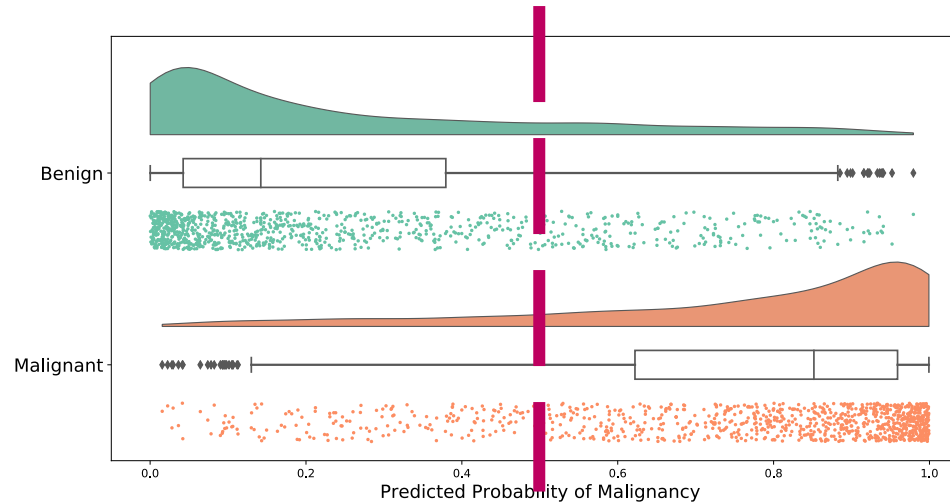


Healthcare Scenarios

1. A computer vision model that detects carcinoma
2. An algorithm that detects atrial fibrillation in Apple Watch users
3. An EHR-based model that monitors autism risk

Operating Point:

balanced

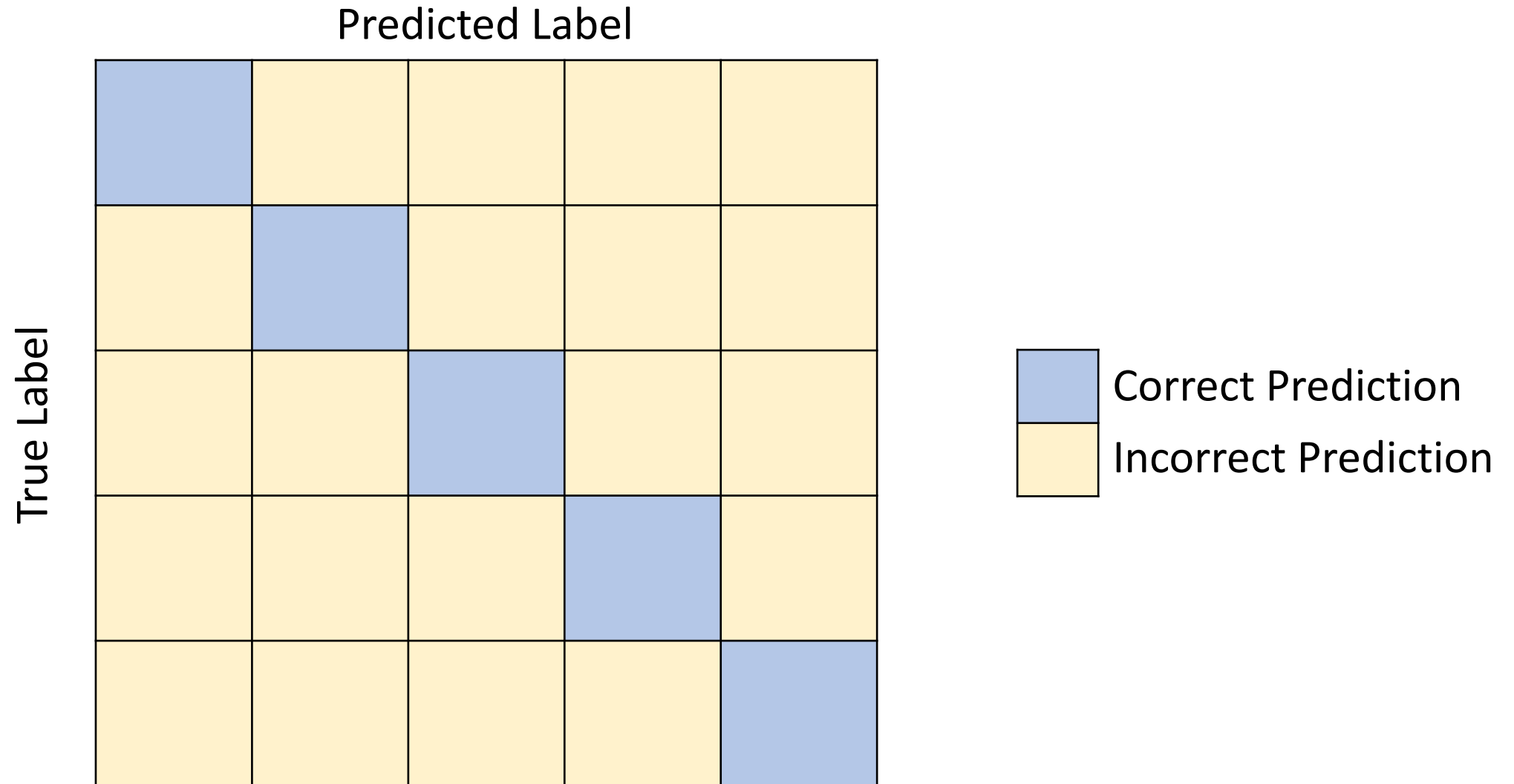


Healthcare Scenarios

1. A computer vision model that detects carcinoma
 2. An algorithm that detects atrial fibrillation in Apple Watch users
 3. An EHR-based model that monitors autism risk
- Sometimes specificity and sensitivity are difficult to interpret, particularly for rare conditions or events.
 - The most clinically relevant measure is often the positive predictive value (or negative predictive value).

Multi-class problems

Multi-class problems: “Confusion Matrix”



Multi-class problems: Binary for Label 1

		Predicted Label			
True Label	True	TruePos	<--- False Negatives --->		
	False				False Pos
	True				
	False				
	True				

True Positives

True Negatives

Correct Prediction

Incorrect Prediction

Multi-class problems: Binary for Label 2

		Predicted Label				
True Label						
		↑	↑	True Negatives		
		←	TruePos	----- False Negatives ----->		
		-----	-----			
		True Negatives	False Positives	True Negatives		
		-----	-----			
		-----	-----			
		-----	-----			
		-----	-----			

Correct Prediction

Incorrect Prediction

Prediction for Ms. Z

After deciding to use the model, you see an 82 year-old woman with a new diagnosis of diastolic heart failure after a recent hospitalization. She had an echo and a cath showing left ventricular hypertrophy and grade 2 diastolic dysfunction with a preserved ejection fraction. She has a history of diabetes and retinopathy and neuropathy.

The model predicts that she is 25% likely (95th percentile) to progress to stage IV CKD within the next 2 years. This prediction is consistent with your clinical impression, so you consider whether to refer her to Nephrology.

Should you refer her? Why or why not?

What level of risk justifies referral?

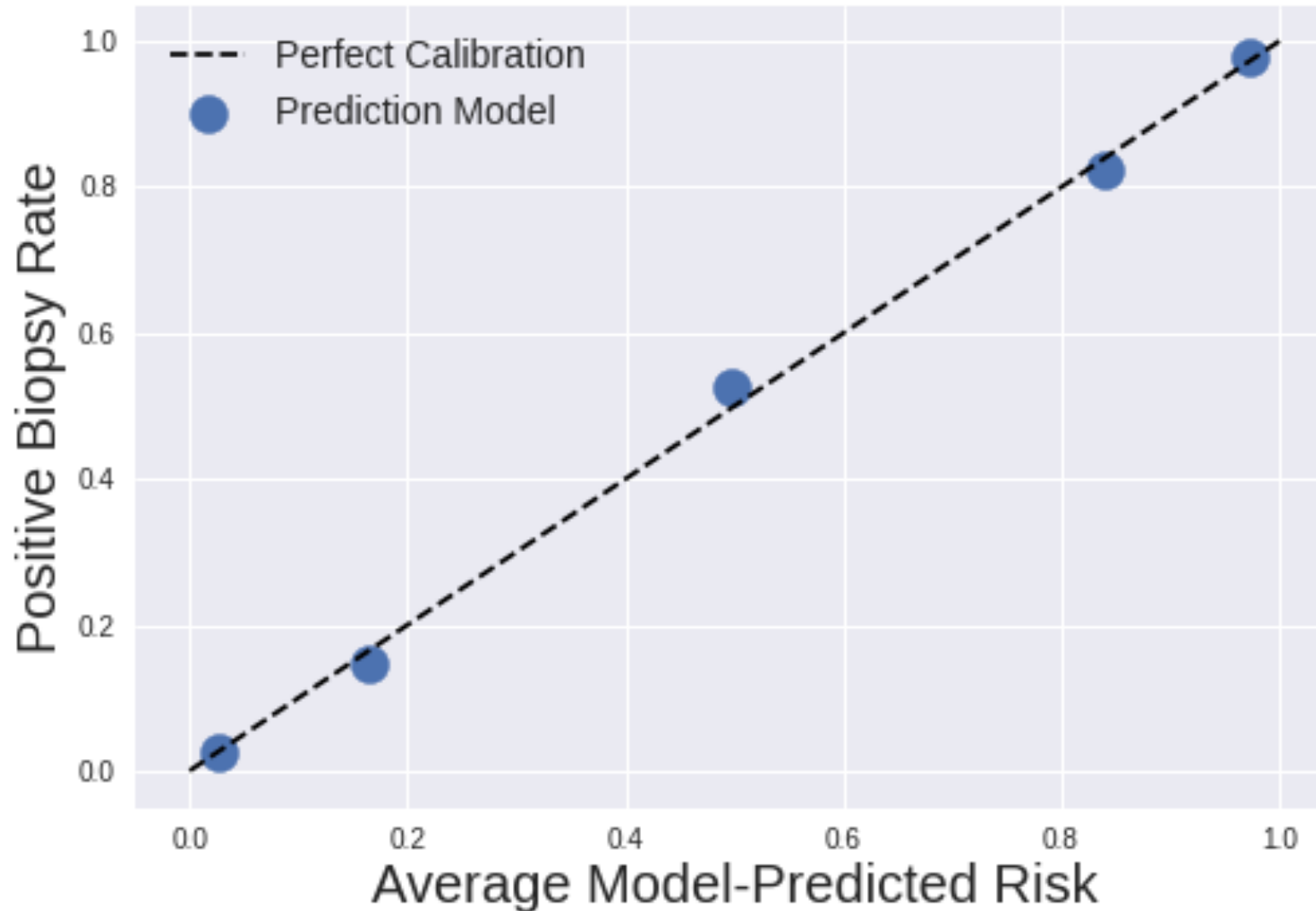
Ms. Z's case leads you to wonder whether referral would be appropriate in more borderline cases.

To make the process more streamlined and consistent, you decide you'd like to refer patients whose risk is above a particular threshold.

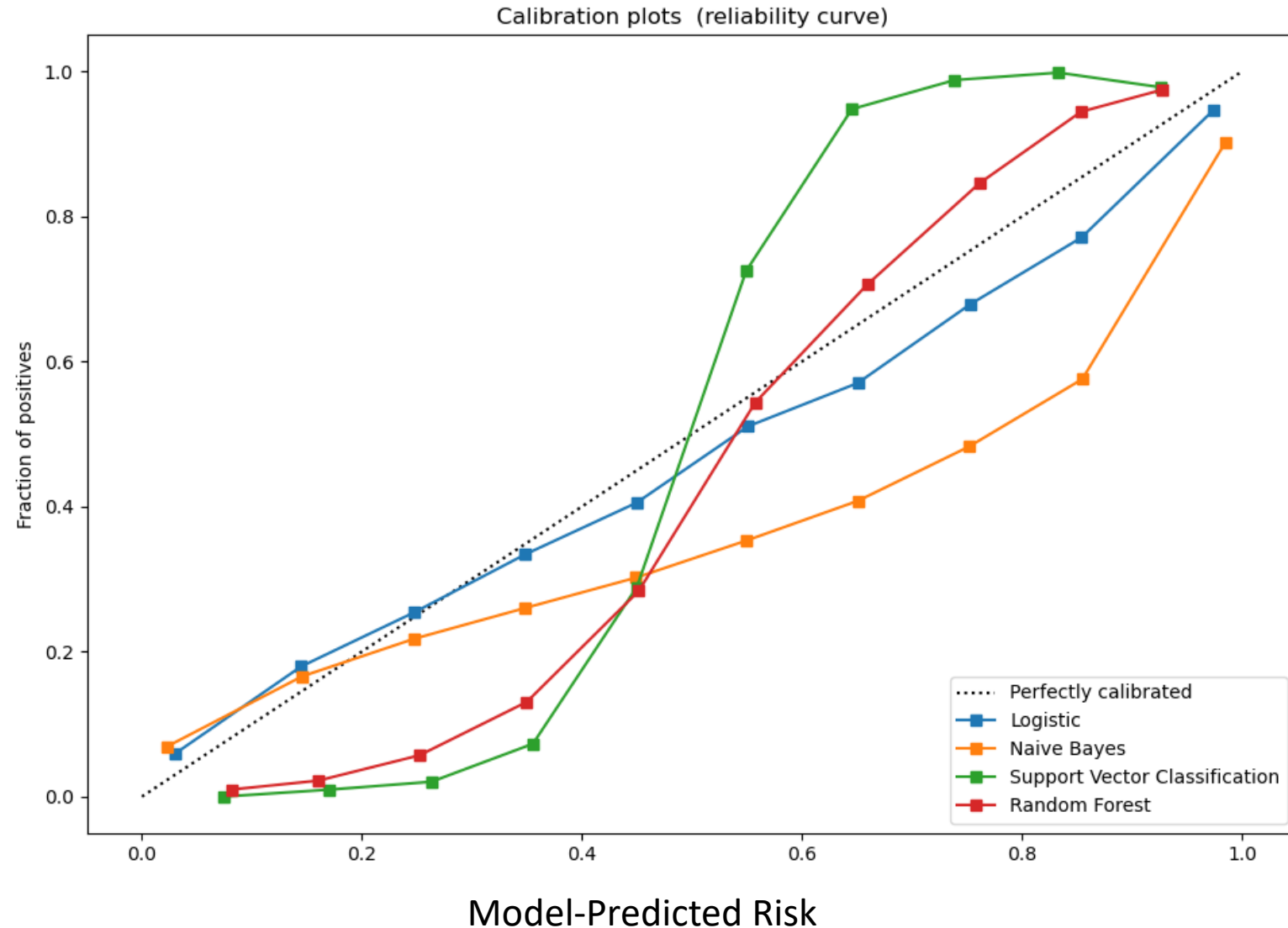
- How do you decide on this threshold?
- Should it be the same for everyone?
- What does your decision say about cost/benefit?

Assessing calibration

Assess Calibration Graphically



Assess Calibration Graphically



Investigating model predictions

Looking inside the black box

Prediction for Mr. X

You've been using your stage IV prediction model for several months now and have found its predictions to be helpful and in line with your clinical judgment.

You see a 32 year-old male patient with new significant hypertension (165/91). You check your model and see it predicts low stage IV CKD risk (<2%). However, on physical exam there is puffiness around his eyes and 1+ edema to his mid-shin. On urinalysis you find significant proteinuria (3+).

The model has been reliable thus far, and you wish to reconcile the findings you're seeing with its predictions.

Report Back: What can you do to investigate?

Key Questions

- What information is available to the model?
 - Predictor groups
 - Timing of collection
 - Lab *ID* or lab *values*?
- What population was used to train the model?
 - Relevant inclusion / exclusion criteria
 - Representation of specific demographics
- What do you know that the model doesn't (or vice versa)?

